

CRIMINAL JUSTICE SYSTEM CPD COURSE 2024



UNDERSTANDING GAMBLING RELATED HARM AND ITS LINKS TO **CRIME**

Impact and Outcomes Report

The Gambling Lived Experience and Recovery Network (GamLEARN) supports and empowers those who have experienced Gambling Related Harm.

Our services are completely FREE to access to those who are in active recovery, or for those affected by someone else's gambling.

We hear you, we believe in you, and we understand.

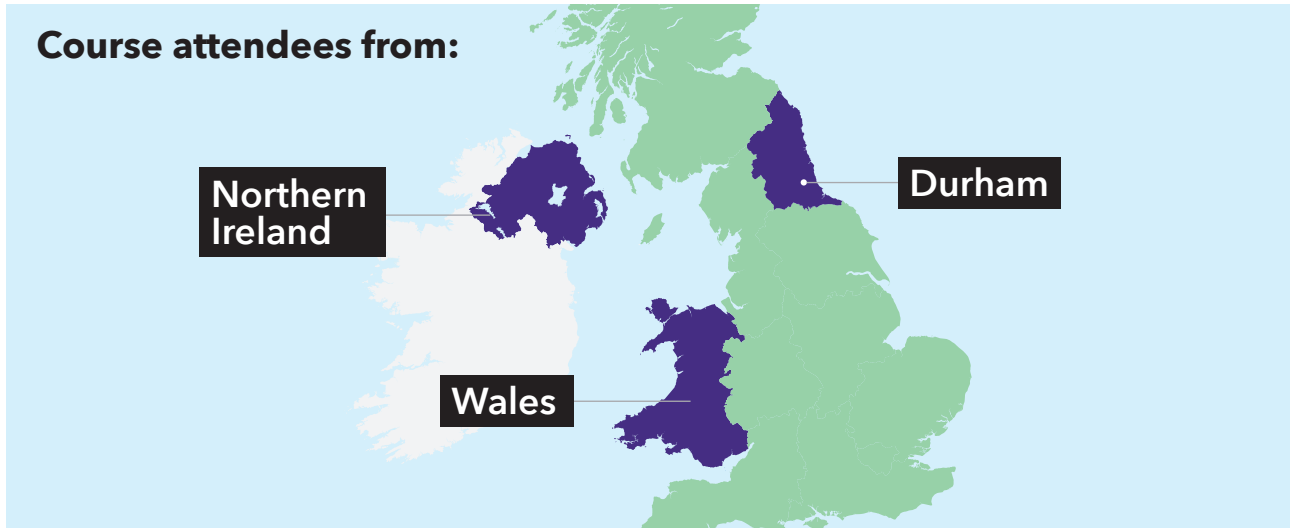
As a charity that embraces the value and experience of our members, we wanted that to be reflected in the work we deliver.

“Understanding gambling related harm and its links to crime” is facilitated by the Charity's members who have gone through the criminal justice system, it also was designed with the help of its members and advisory panel, including video content by people's journeys and experiences.



Over eight months in 2024, our lived experience facilitators delivered our CPD course to professionals across the UK from a wide range of sectors, raising awareness of gambling related harm and its links to crime amongst the service users they support in the course of their day to day roles.

Course attendees from:



Attendee Job Titles included:

Advanced Health Practitioner
Assistant Psychologist
Community Engagement Officer
Harm Reduction Outreach Worker
Partnership Integration Co-ordinator
Police Inspector
Prison Officer

Probation Services Officer
PSO Court Officer
Public Health Practitioner
Reducing Reoffending Manager
Rough Sleeper Outreach Worker
Substance Misuse Officer

Organisations included:





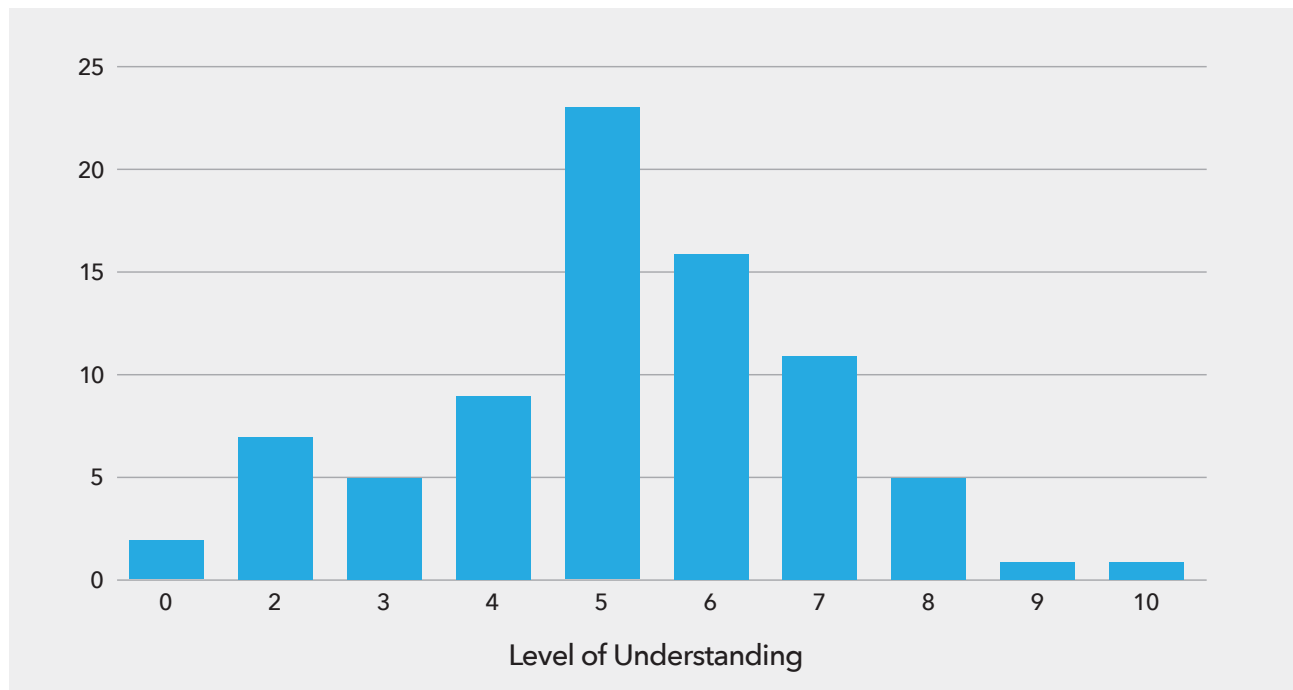
***"This was the best training I have had.
The facilitators were fantastic and
interactive. Their lived experience was
invaluable and really made the training
stand out. The videos and statistics
were really interesting."***

The key aims of this course are to:

- raise awareness of gambling as an addiction and recognised mental health disorder
- provide professionals with the knowledge to recognise signs of gambling related harm
- to ensure professionals know who to refer to

Before the course started 80 attendees gave a score out of 10, of their understanding of gambling related harm (0 = no understanding, 10 = highest level of understanding)

The majority (59) respondents gave scores of 4-7

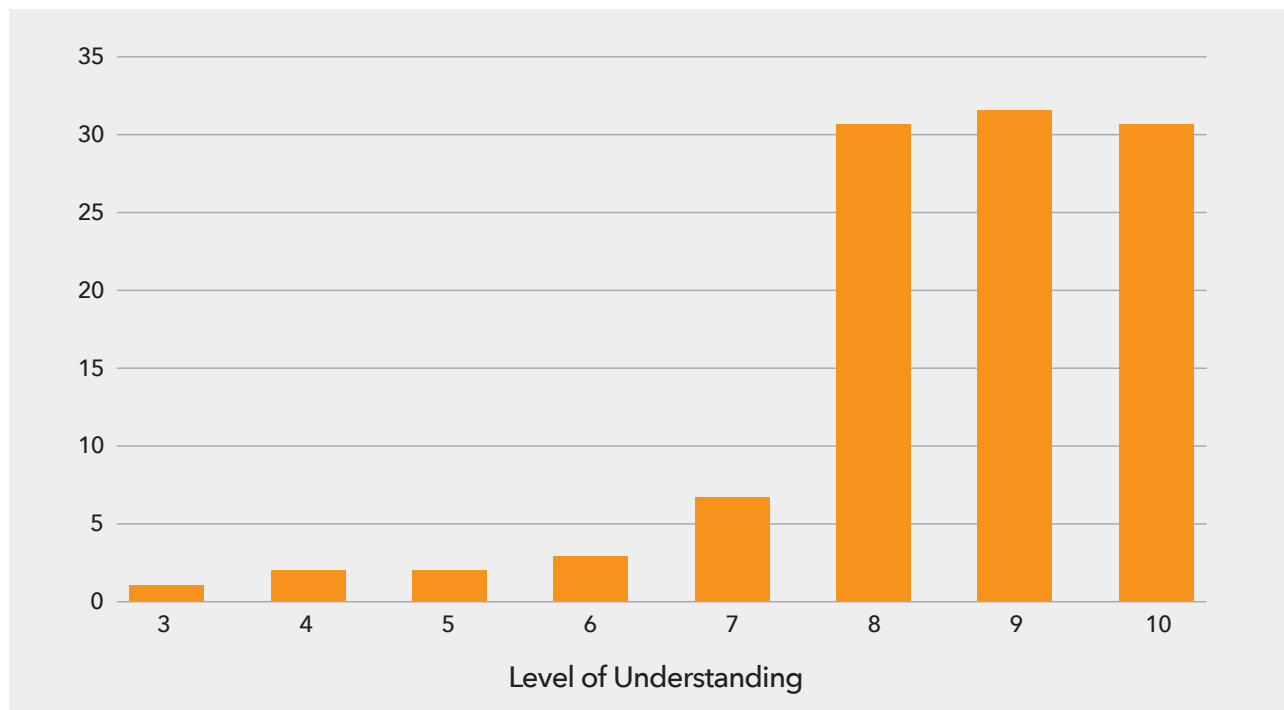


"Before I did not really know the severity of gambling addiction. I knew there was such a thing as gambling addiction, but never knew the inside of how it possess people into do anything, including crime to get money to continue to gamble. I did not realise that gambling can start from such a young age, my personal experience, I will buy two scratch cards and let my 6-year-old do one - that will stop now!"

"I would be more mindful of my language and use a gambling related harm approach. I would ask a service user directly if they gamble then expand from that question. I feel more equipped to referring them onto support services whether its online or in person. When supporting a service user with a financially motivated crime, I would be more mindful if gambling could be a contributing factor to their offending and how I could support them moving forward."

Following the course 112 attendees were asked the same question.

97 respondents gave scores of 8-10



"Excellent training - relevant, engaging use of materials and information. Interesting and previously unknown-to-me facts. Open discussions and dialogue with lived experiences and a clear focus upon improving awareness and helping others."

"The lived experience is very interesting; I think it's important to hear from people who have experienced the issue themselves."

"This is the best training I have attended in a very long time. Very informative and eye opening. Loved the true stories and how we can help as practitioners! Thank you."

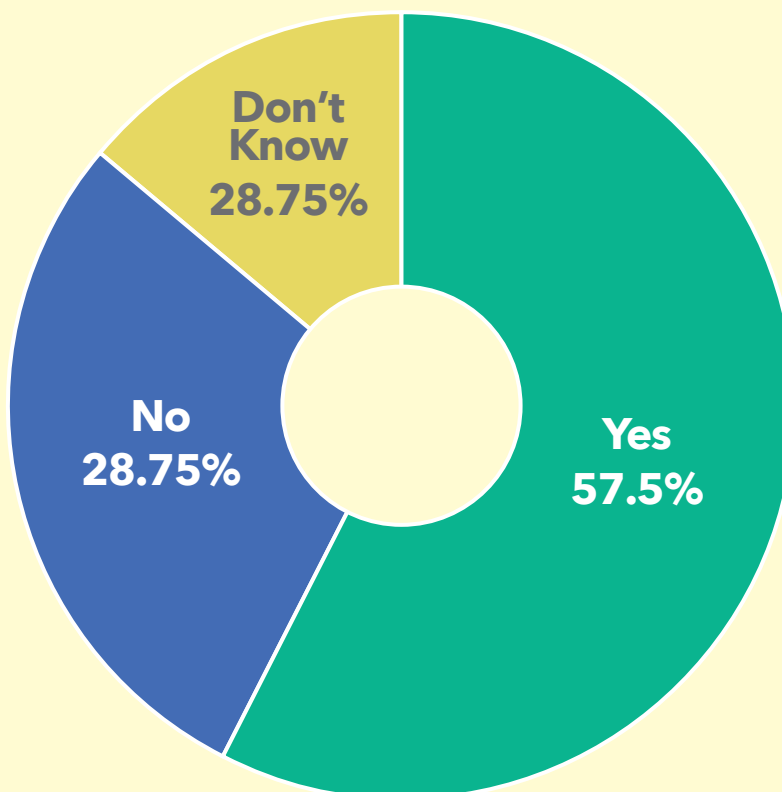
"Videos were great to watch - person touch to the topic and not just purely stats and data."

"This training is so relevant and needed within all aspects of the criminal justice system. My recommendation would be to deliver this to as many staff as possible - from arrest to sentencing to supervision. Thank you very much."

"It has everything in terms of pitching the learning - I recommend that this needs to be right in the middle of the table for involvement at all levels of our HMPPS structure. A policy change to align gambling harms with other established addictions is the next step."

How many attendees during their **day to day work** had **previously been directly involved** with an individual who has experienced Gambling Related Harm?

Yes 57.5% No 28.75% Not sure 13.75%



"Raise awareness of the health related harms from Gambling as well as sign posting to GamLEARN for those who may require support or who want additional learning. I will also consider how my role as health and justice partnership coordinator can improve things for people on probation or those within the service who may be worried about gambling."

"I am grateful to be given the opportunity to go on this course, because not only did I learn about gambling, gambling addictions – but also the seriousness of it, the vicious circle people can get into, the consequence on family and friends, the risks of losing everything (including life)."

"I feel as if I can be brave enough now to ask if someone gambles now, and if so, how it is affecting their lives. Thankfully we now have resource material and referrals from GamLEARN to help support. I do feel not enough is being done in the North of Ireland to help with gambling, so it is practical and great to have support."

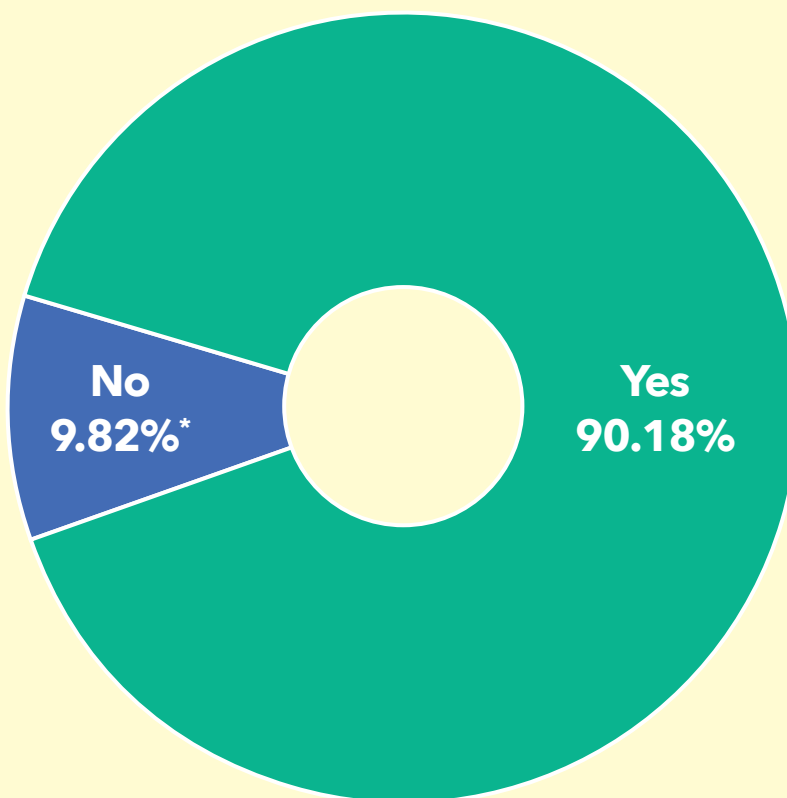
Course Impact

Out of the 112 respondents who completed a post-course assessment, we found the following results.

Did the course:

- raise awareness of gambling as an addiction and recognised mental health disorder?

Yes 90.18% No 9.82%*



*n=11. 3 reduction, 8 maintained pre-course awareness

"The training was excellent, the knowledge of the training team and the ability to give honest and open answers to questions asked showed the understanding of a person with lived experience. The breadth of discussion re the course content was particularly useful when thinking about commissioning future services. And the intersectional links raised with gambling and substance misuse addiction was interesting, particularly when thinking about available treatment. But it was shocking to hear the stories about wider gambling harms, particularly crime, debt and suicidal thoughts."

"The booklet with all the slides is a great tool, I made notes in this and can refer back."

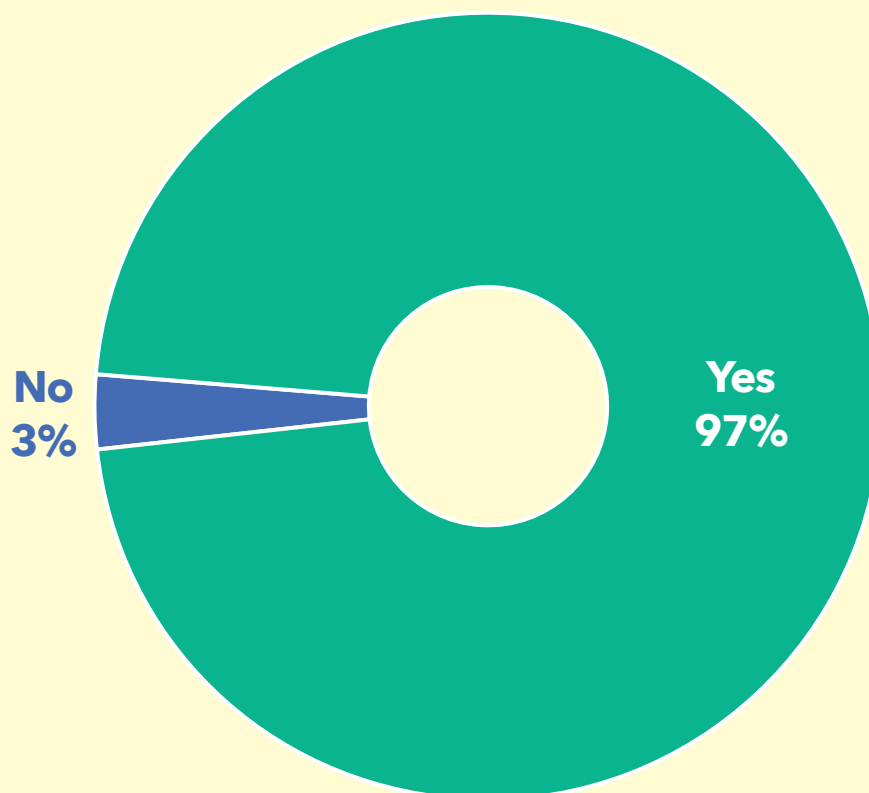
"I will ask more questions with gambling in mind and look for signs."

"I will be prepared to discuss the brain changes in addiction and hope that will help with feelings of shame. I will think of gambling as a mitigating rather than an aggravating factor."

Did the course:

- provide professionals with the knowledge to recognise signs of gambling related harm?

Yes 97% No 3%



"I feel confident in my understanding but also the process as well as the guidance to better help support an individual."

"I'll be more confident in asking the question "do you gamble" when discussing financial issues. I'll be better able to ascertain how much of an impact it has on their life and know who to refer them to if they need help."

"A better understanding of the addiction. Increased empathy. Hearing all of your perspectives will definitely help me work with male service users. I think it will also help me look for red flags."

Did the course:

- help to ensure professionals know who to refer to?

"I'll be more confident in asking the question "do you gamble" when discussing financial issues. I'll be better able to ascertain how much of an impact it has on their life and know who to refer them to if they need help."

"Refer and attempt to signpost to support."

"Can refer my service-user to a specific support agency which is not available in NI."

"I now have more understanding and I am aware of the support there is to refer people to"

"I am better informed about referral routes and signposting opportunity for affected individuals and their family."

"Will ask if they gamble and need help and support rather than avoiding the question as I would not previously know where to refer."

"Promote GamLEARN to our service users, statutory and community partners."

"Signpost service users to the support organisations highlighted in the training materials."

Understanding Gambling Related Harm and its links to crime

How gambling can negatively impact an individual's mental health, overall well-being, their lives, and their actions.

It is important to understand why some individuals may turn to crime as a result of gambling. We will explore the concept of 'Gambling Related Harm' and how it can potentially lead to criminal behaviour. By shedding light on this issue, we hope to promote a better understanding of the risks associated with gambling and its impact on society.

Learning outcomes:

- Understand what Gambling Related Harm is and how that it can lead to crime
- Research and data which highlight the prevalence of gambling in the UK
- The role of products through promotion and AI
- How suicide is also a high risk within the gambling harms space
- Understand the support and treatment services available for individuals



Limitations

- Sample size was 146
- Not all who filled in the pre-course could attend on the day, and some people who attended the course only filled in the post-course questionnaire.
- Several forms were duplicated and removed from the cohort.
- Lack of funding
- Lack of strategy in place across the CJS
- Lack of screening amongst service users

Next Steps

Amendments to the data gathering process will be made to ensure consistency in reporting. For example, a specific 'do you know who to refer to' question with a 'yes/no' option.

The course is due to run for the remainder of 2024 and an annual analysis report will be produced for each year it runs.

Comments

The course is proving to be very popular with planned delivery for the whole of 2024 taking place in the first quarter due to demand. Based on feedback from participants the course is being further refined, data gathering enhanced and future reports will benefit from further analysis.

This impact and outcomes report was undertaken by Swanson Buck Ltd.

If you are interested in booking a session or would like more information, please contact **tracy@gamlearn.org.uk**